

3.2 Reflection

John Berger's ideas on oil painting and possessions talks about how one can notice how much modern visual culture is connected to materialism. Berger also explains about how traditional oil paintings showed wealth, property, status and possessions. In present time, I believe publicity and social media have taken over a similar role. Luxury items, designer clothes, expensive homes are portrayed to represent success by advertisements and social media, instead of paintings. I think we still follow the same idea today because having more things nowadays is associated with success and happiness. For instance - advertisement for expensive products don't only show the products but also a lifestyle that makes the viewer imagine living a similar lifestyle. Social media can do similar things because people share a lot of branded things - like places they visit or experiences they can afford. This makes possessions seem connected to happiness. Simultaneously I do not think everybody believes the same thing about money and possessions being the most important things. Many also value relationships, education, personal goals etc. Despite that I still believe modern publicity does heavily influence what we think success looks like. Berger's idea made me realise that even though tech. has changed - the connection between images and status is still present in modern visual culture.